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Strategic Trading Analysis

Step 1: Audit the Data

- **Data Present:** Comprehensive technical indicators (Daily, Weekly, and 15-Min charts, 20/50/200 EMAs, MACD, RSI, Bollinger Bands, Supertrend), Volume analysis (Distribution days, Climax volume), Relative Strength vs. Benchmark, and baseline Fundamental/Analyst data (EPS growth, consensus targets).
- **Data Missing:** Options open interest (derivatives data) to gauge current institutional positioning, order book depth, and specific fundamental news catalysts explaining the recent aggressive gap-down.
- **Confidence Level: High**. The provided multi-timeframe and multi-indicator data is robust enough to establish a clear technical profile and risk assessment for a positional trade.

Step 2: Analyze the Setup

From a positional trading perspective (1-4 months), the primary requirement is a favorable trend or a confirmed structural reversal. ITC.NS currently displays a severely broken market structure:* **Trend & Price Structure:** The stock is in a steep, confirmed downtrend across the Daily and Weekly timeframes. It recently suffered a massive gap-down, breaking well below its 200-day and 200-week EMAs. * **Momentum:** Highly bearish. Price is submerged below the 20, 50, and 200 EMAs. The Daily Supertrend is firmly in a "Sell" state. * **Volume & Supply:** The volume analysis detects 4 recent "Distribution Days" and a massive spike in selling volume. The large gap-down has created a significant pocket of overhead supply; any dead-cat bounce will likely face aggressive selling from trapped participants.* **Divergence:** While there is a noted MACD/RSI bullish divergence and "Climax Volume (Churning)" suggesting the *potential* for short-term seller exhaustion, these are counter-trend signals. In a strong downtrend, momentum indicators can remain oversold for extended periods.

Attempting to catch a falling knife in a fundamentally weakening short-term picture (QoQ Revenue -6.81%, Net Income -5.97%) violates core risk-management principles for intermediate-term trend trading.

Step 3: Formulate the Recommendation

Recommendation: NO, you should not enter this stock right now.

Why invalid: Positional setups require a defined shift in the supply/demand balance. Currently, sellers are in absolute control. Entering now is entirely predictive rather than reactive. The risk of further downside outweighs the potential for a 5%-15% mean-reversion bounce. A solid base needs to be built to absorb the overhead supply before a high-probability uptrend can resume.

Conditional Plan (If a reversal structure develops): Wait for a confirmed base to form and for short-term momentum to shift back to the buyers.

- **Condition to Buy:** A daily close above both the 20-day EMA (~304) and the Daily Supertrend resistance (~312) on above-average volume, confirming a new sequence of higher highs and higher lows.

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- **Entry Price:** INR 315.00 (Hypothetical trigger confirming a structural breakout above near-term resistance).

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- **Stop Loss:** INR 288.00 (Hard stop just below the recent swing low and the Lower Bollinger Band to protect against trend continuation).

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- **Take Profit:** INR 360.00 (Hypothetical target aimed at the 200-day EMA and the lower boundary of the recent gap-down, offering roughly a ~14% upside).

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Candlestick Classification Analysis

Based on the provided Candlestick Classification summary (Page 20) and the visual chart (Page 21), here is an analysis from the perspective of a seasoned price action trader using your specific classification algorithm.

1. Macro Context & The Shift in Control

Looking at the chart on Page 21, ITC.NS has undergone a massive structural breakdown. For the first half of the chart, the stock was consolidating in the 390-420 range.

However, just before the "2026-01-08" marker on the x-axis, there is a glaring **"Seller Strong Control" (-2, Dark Red)** candle accompanied by the largest volume spike on the entire chart. * **Applying your logic:** This indicates a large body (>1.5 ATR), closing near its absolute low (high conviction), with a massive volume multiplier (>1.3x avg). This was institutional capitulation and a total transfer of power to the bears. The fact that the price has not even attempted to retrace half of this breakdown candle shows heavy overhead supply.

2. Breakdown of the Classification Data (Page 20)

The aggregate data paints a picture of a bleeding asset with no buyers stepping in to catch the falling knife:* **Total Distribution:** 63 days of Seller Control (-1 and -2) vs. only 48 days of Buyer Control (+1 and +2). * **The Indecision Factor:** The most common candle is **"No Control" (0)** with 117 occurrences. In a strong downtrend, "No Control" candles (small bodies, long wicks, average volume) do not represent a bottom; they represent bearish consolidation or "pauses" before the next leg down. * **Recent Trend Score (-0.50):** The 10-day moving average of the candlestick scores is exactly -0.50. In a system ranging from -2 to +2, sitting at -0.50 over a two-week period means the tape is dominated by "Seller Control" (-1) days intermixed with "No Control" (0) days. **Buyers are completely absent.**

3. Recent Price Action (Far Right of Chart)

Zooming in on the latest price action near the ~290-300 level:* **Lack of Step 4 (Volume) Validation for Buyers:** Any green candles appearing in the current downtrend are pale green (**Buyer Control +1**). According to your algorithm, this means they either have weak bodies, or they attempted a strong move but were *downgraded due to low volume*. There is no institutional buying (no dark green candles) to halt the slide.* **Wick Rejections (Step 3):** The recent minor consolidations show upper wicks forming. As per your Step 3 logic, long upper wicks trigger a bearish adjustment because they show failed attempts by buyers to push the price higher. Sellers immediately defend lower highs.* **Current Status:** The latest classification is **No Control**. The price is drifting horizontally with low volatility, forming what looks like a bearish pennant or flag.

4. Future Price Prediction

Prediction: The path of least resistance remains strictly DOWN (Bearish).

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Reasoning based on your system: To predict a reversal or a bottom, your algorithm would need to print a sequence of **Buyer Strong Control (+2)** candles on high volume to absorb the overhead supply, or at least a cluster of **No Control (0)** candles with long lower wicks (showing buyers defending the lows).

Currently, we see neither. The high-volume nodes remain heavily skewed to the sell side, and the recent "-0.50" trend score indicates a slow, agonizing bleed. The current "No Control" phase is simply the market catching its breath. Because buyers are showing zero conviction (failing Steps 1, 2, and 4 of your algorithm during bounce attempts), sellers will likely take advantage of the low liquidity to push the price to new structural lows.

Trading Stance: Sell rallies. Any push upward that prints a "No Control" (0) or weak "Buyer Control" (+1) on low volume should be viewed as a shorting opportunity, anticipating further downside continuation.

News & Analyst Targets

As a stock research analyst, I have reviewed the latest market data, macroeconomic triggers, and brokerage notes for ITC Ltd. as of late March 2026.

Here is the comprehensive research summary addressing your specific queries:

1) Latest News for ITC This Week (Late March 2026)

- **Hitting a 52-Week Low:** Despite broader market rebounds, ITC shares have faced severe selling pressure this week, hitting a new 52-week low of INR 288.75 on the NSE. The stock is currently down over 27% year-to-date for FY2026, marking its second straight year of negative returns and heavily underperforming the broader market.
- **High-Value Trading & Technical Weakness:** On March 24, 2026, ITC witnessed one of the highest value turnovers on the market (over INR 333 crores worth of shares traded). However, technical indicators show the stock is in an "oversold" territory (RSI below 30) and trading well below its 50-day, 100-day, and 200-day moving averages.
- **Pricing Strategy Implementation:** To combat the recent aggressive tax hikes, ITC has implemented a "three-pronged" pricing strategy. This includes shrinking the length of some sticks to maintain the INR 9.5 price point, raising prices on premium 84mm sticks (from INR 17 to INR 24), and partially subsidizing its highest volume segment to prevent massive volume loss.
- **ITC Hotels Demerger Follow-up:** Following the successful demerger and listing of ITC Hotels earlier this year, news has surfaced that British American Tobacco (BAT) is preparing for a phased sale of its 14.55% stake in the newly listed hospitality entity.

2) Upgrades and Downgrades from Brokerages

Following the government's aggressive implementation of a new 40% GST rate on cigarettes alongside heavy specific excise duties (effective February 1, 2026), there has been a massive wave of **downgrades** across the analyst community. * **MarketsMojo:** Downgraded ITC from "Hold" to "Sell" in late February/March 2026 due to deteriorating technicals, breaking of long-term support zones, and weakening fundamentals.* **Prabhudas Lilladher & Nomura:** Both downgraded the stock to "Reduce," citing that the massive tax increases will force ITC to hike prices by up to 30%, which could trigger a steep double-digit decline in sales

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volumes.* **Motilal Oswal & JPMorgan:** Downgraded the stock from "Buy" to "Neutral." They noted that such a sharp tax increase was unprecedented in recent years and requires a severe valuation multiple reset.* **Jefferies & Nuvama:** Downgraded from "Buy" to "Hold," slashing earnings estimates and pointing out that the magnitude of the tax hike broke the benign tax regime ITC had enjoyed for the last few years.* *Maintained Ratings:* A few brokerages, like DAM Capital and BofA Securities, have maintained a "Buy" rating, arguing that the negatives are largely priced in and the stock's 5% dividend yield provides a strong margin of safety.

3) Other News Directly or Indirectly Impacting ITC

- **Direct Impact - The Statutory NCCD Overhang:** In the 2026 Budget, the government quietly raised the statutory limit for the National Calamity Contingent Duty (NCCD) on tobacco products from 25% to 60%. While the *effective* rate remains at 25% for now, this creates a massive policy overhang. It gives the government the legislative room to hike taxes further at any moment without passing a new bill, keeping investors extremely cautious.
- **Indirect Impact - Threat of Illicit Trade:** Brokerages have flagged that the mandated price hikes of 20-40% across key brands will severely widen the price gap between legal, tax-paying cigarettes and illicit/smuggled ones. This is indirectly threatening ITC's market share in the organized sector.
- **Indirect Impact - FMCG Diversification Focus:** With the capital-heavy hotel business completely off its books, ITC is aggressively utilizing its freed-up capital to expand its FMCG and agriculture segments. The market is closely watching if robust FMCG volume growth can offset the profitability hit taken by the tobacco division.

4) Latest Targets from Analyst Community & Brokerages (March 2026)

Below is a consolidated summary of the revised target prices and ratings for ITC following the Q4/Budget 2026 fallout:

Brokerage / Analyst Firm	Revised Rating	Latest Target Price (INR)
BofA Securities	Buy	470
DAM Capital	Buy	440
Nuvama	Hold	415
Jefferies	Hold	400
Motilal Oswal	Neutral	400
Centrum	Neutral	390
JPMorgan	Neutral	375
Emkay Global	Reduce	350
Prabhudas Lilladher	Reduce	348
Morgan Stanley	Equal-Weight	346
Nomura	Reduce	340
Macquarie	Neutral	330

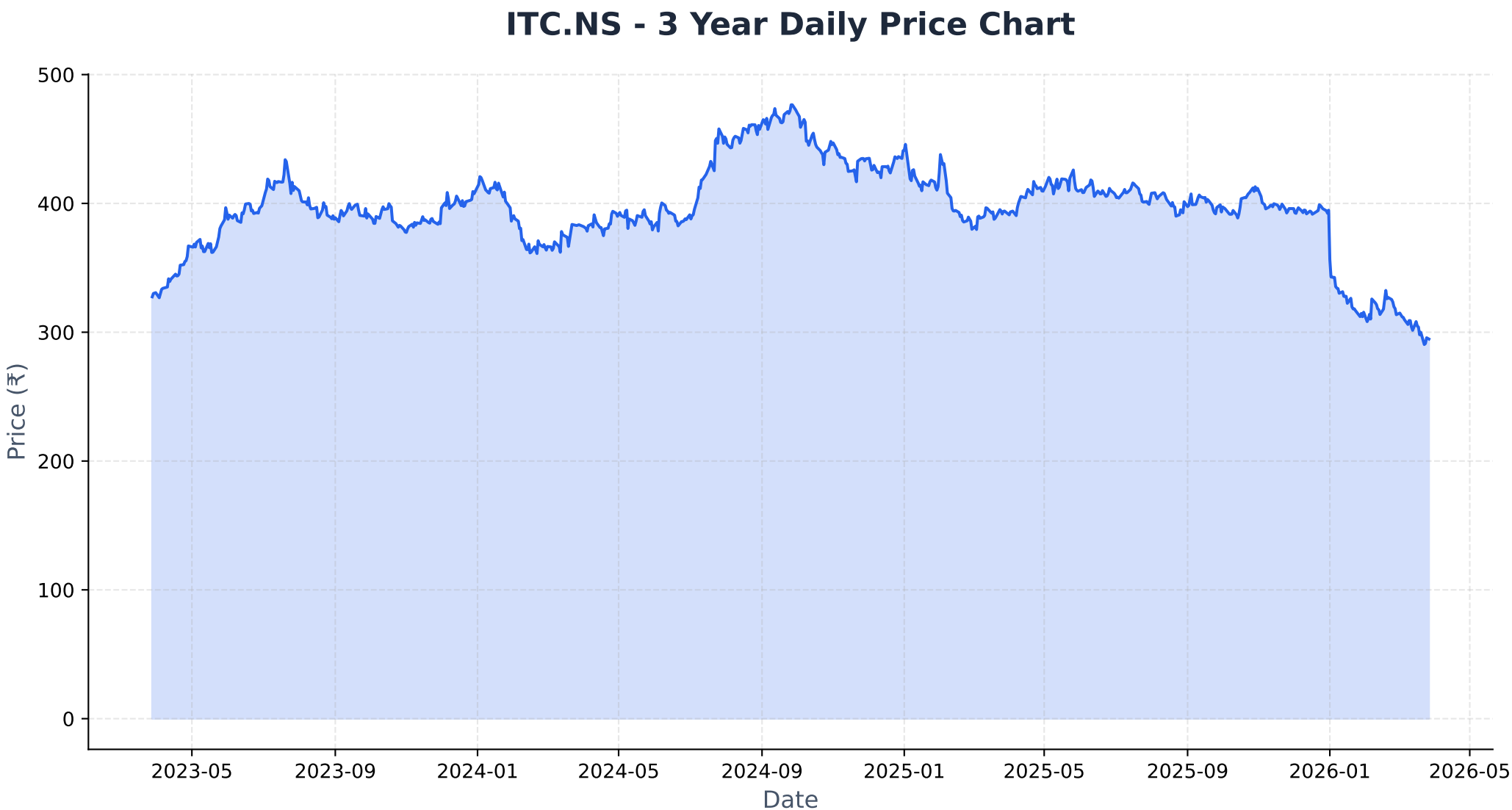
Disclaimer: As an analyst, I must note that ITC is currently experiencing extreme volatility due to regulatory tax shifts. The high dividend yield (~5%) acts as a psychological floor, but technical indicators suggest downward momentum could persist until Q4 earnings offer clarity on exact volume contraction.

Stock Detailed Analysis Report

ITC.NS

Current Price: ₹294.70

Generated: 2026-03-28 11:53


ITC.NS - 3 Year Daily Price Chart
500
400
300
200
100
0
Price (₹)
2023-05
2023-09
2024-01
2024-05
2024-09
2025-01
2025-05
2025-09
2026-01
2026-05
Date

Long-term Fundamental Analysis (4 Years)

Metric	Is Growing?	Accelerating?	1Y Growth	3Y CAGR
Revenue	Yes	Yes	10.78%	7.51%
Net Income	Yes	Yes	69.84%	31.61%
ROE	Yes	Yes	80.69%	26.68%
EPS	Yes	Yes	69.24%	30.97%

Short-term Fundamental Analysis (6 Quarters)

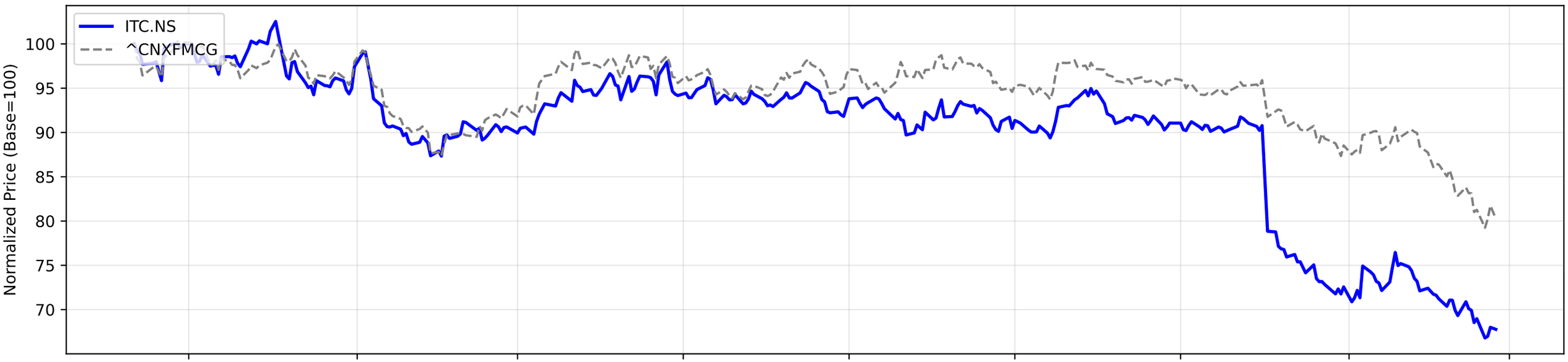
Metric	Is Growing?	Recent QoQ	Avg QoQ
Revenue	Yes	-6.81%	0.47%
Net Income	Yes	-5.97%	54.80%
ROE	Yes	324.65%	324.65%
EPS	No	-5.97%	-3.06%

ITC.NS - Relative Strength Analysis

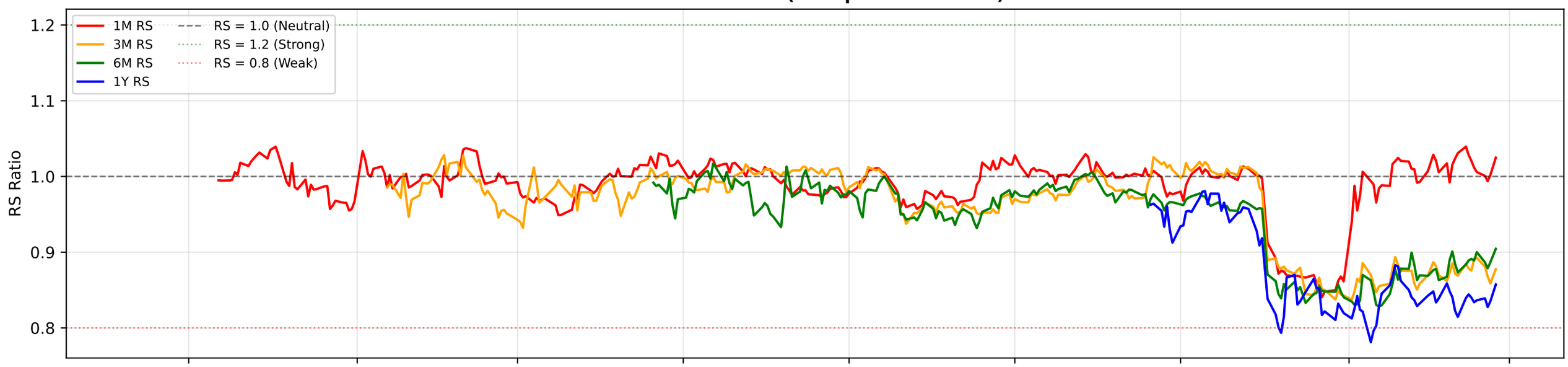
═══ OVERVIEW ═══:	
Benchmark Index:	^CNXFMCG
Sector:	FMCG
Classification:	**Emerging Leader**
RS Score:	46.3/100
:	
═══ RS RATIOS ═══:	
1M RS:	**1.025 [Leader]**
3M RS:	**0.878 [Neutral]**
6M RS:	**0.904 [Neutral]**
1Y RS:	**0.857 [Neutral]**
:	
═══ TURNAROUND ANALYSIS ═══:	
Turnaround Status:	**Not Detected**
:	
SIGNAL CRITERIA::	
✓ **Emerging RS:**	1M (1.025) > 3M (0.878)
✓ **Medium-term Lagging:**	6M=0.904, 1Y=0.857 (≤1.0)
✗ **Performance Improving:**	**Not improving**

Relative Strength Analysis: ITC.NS vs ^CNXFMCG
Classification: Emerging Leader

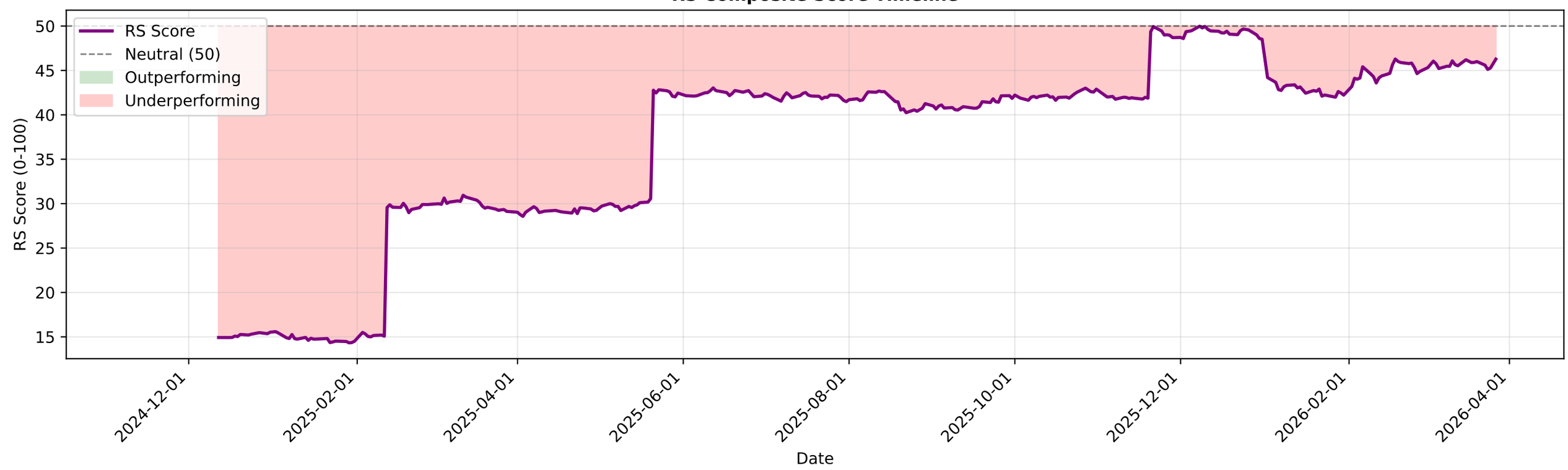
Price Performance Comparison (Normalized)



RS Ratio Trends (Multiple Timeframes)

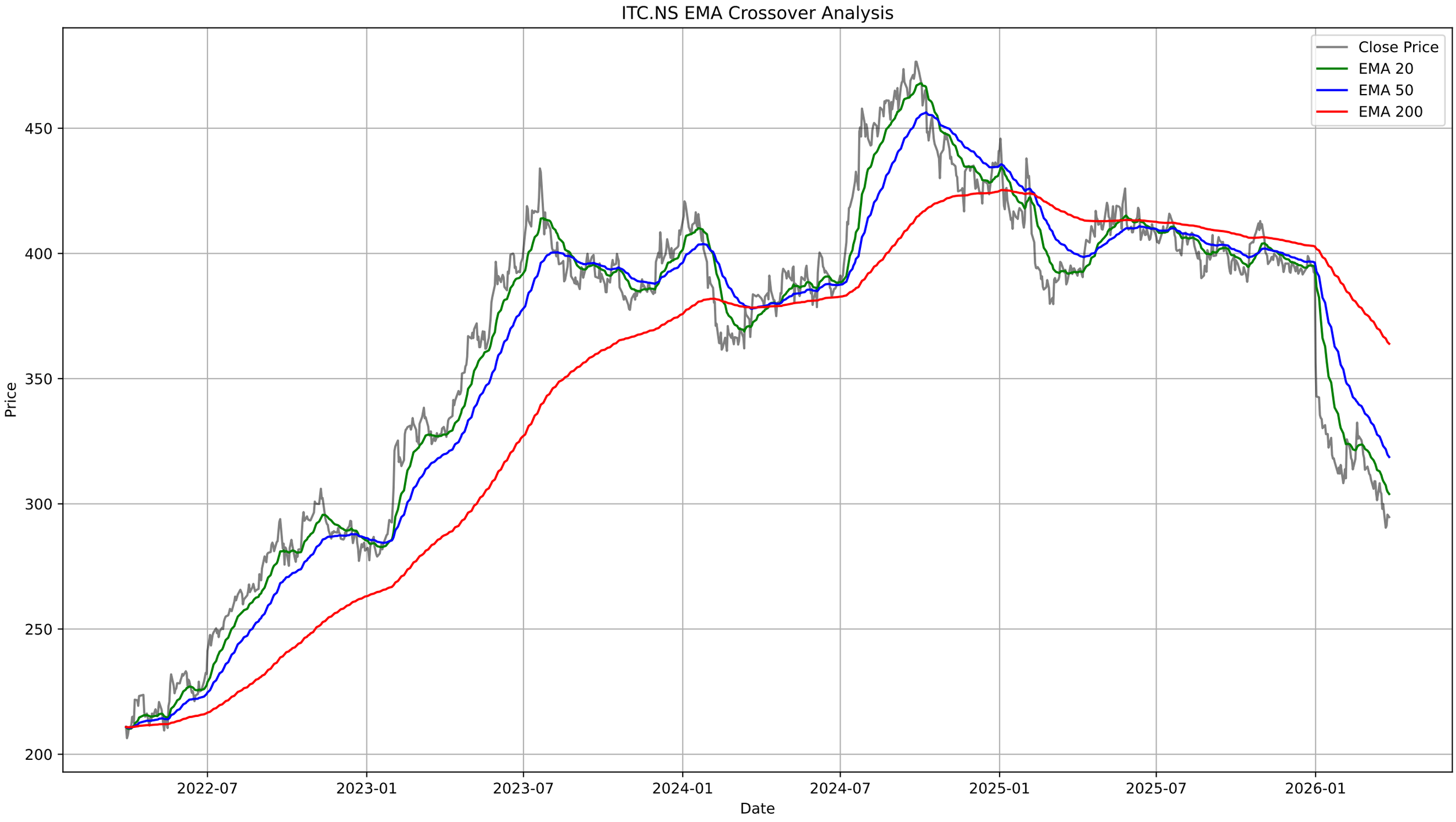


RS Composite Score Timeline



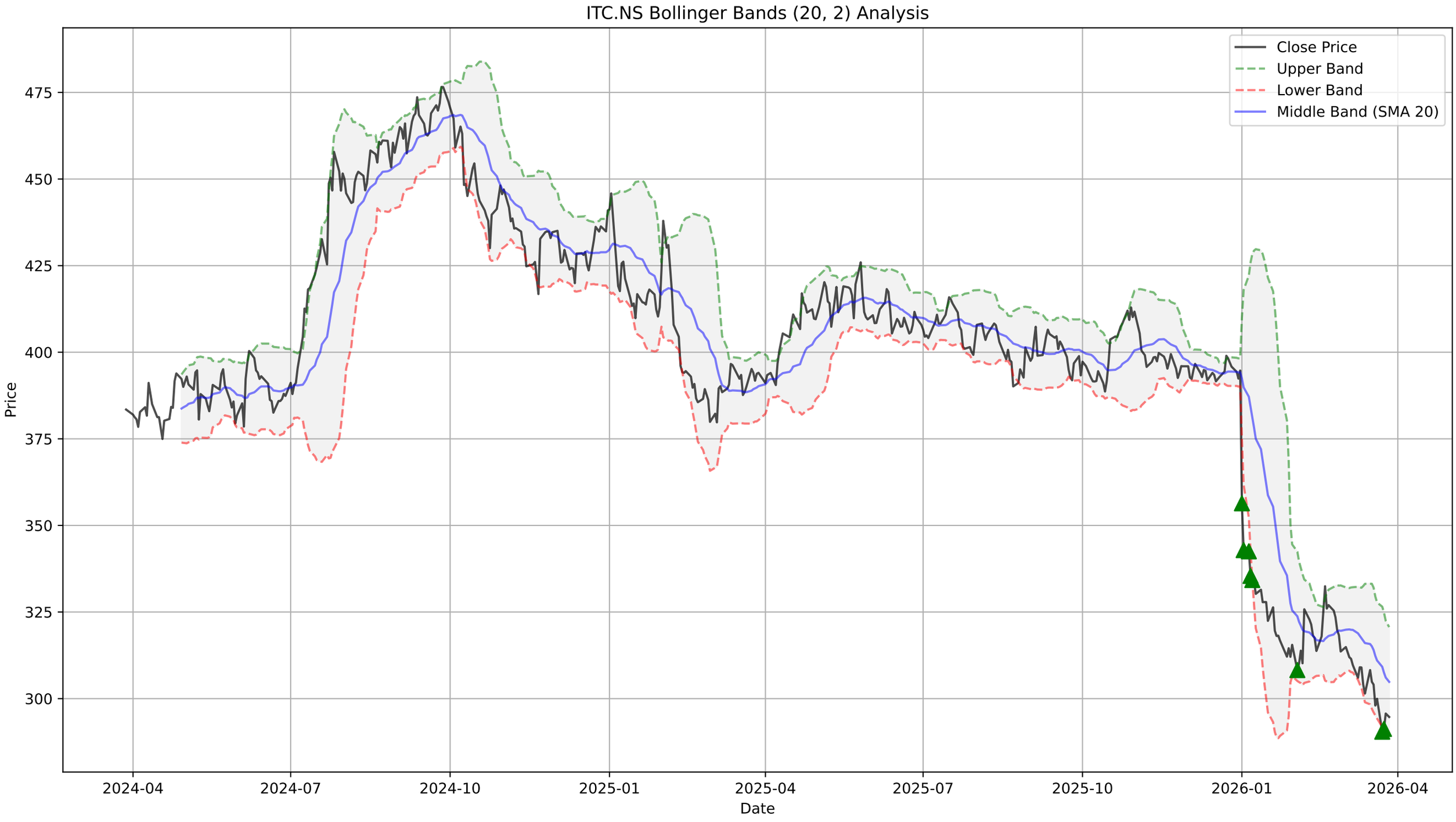
ITC.NS - EMA Crossover Summary

EMA 20:	303.92
EMA 50:	318.70
EMA 200:	363.93
Trend Status:	**Strong Downtrend**


ITC.NS EMA Crossover Analysis
Close Price
EMA 20
EMA 50
EMA 200
Price
450
400
350
300
250
200
2022-07
2023-01
2023-07
2024-01
2024-07
2025-01
2025-07
2026-01
Date

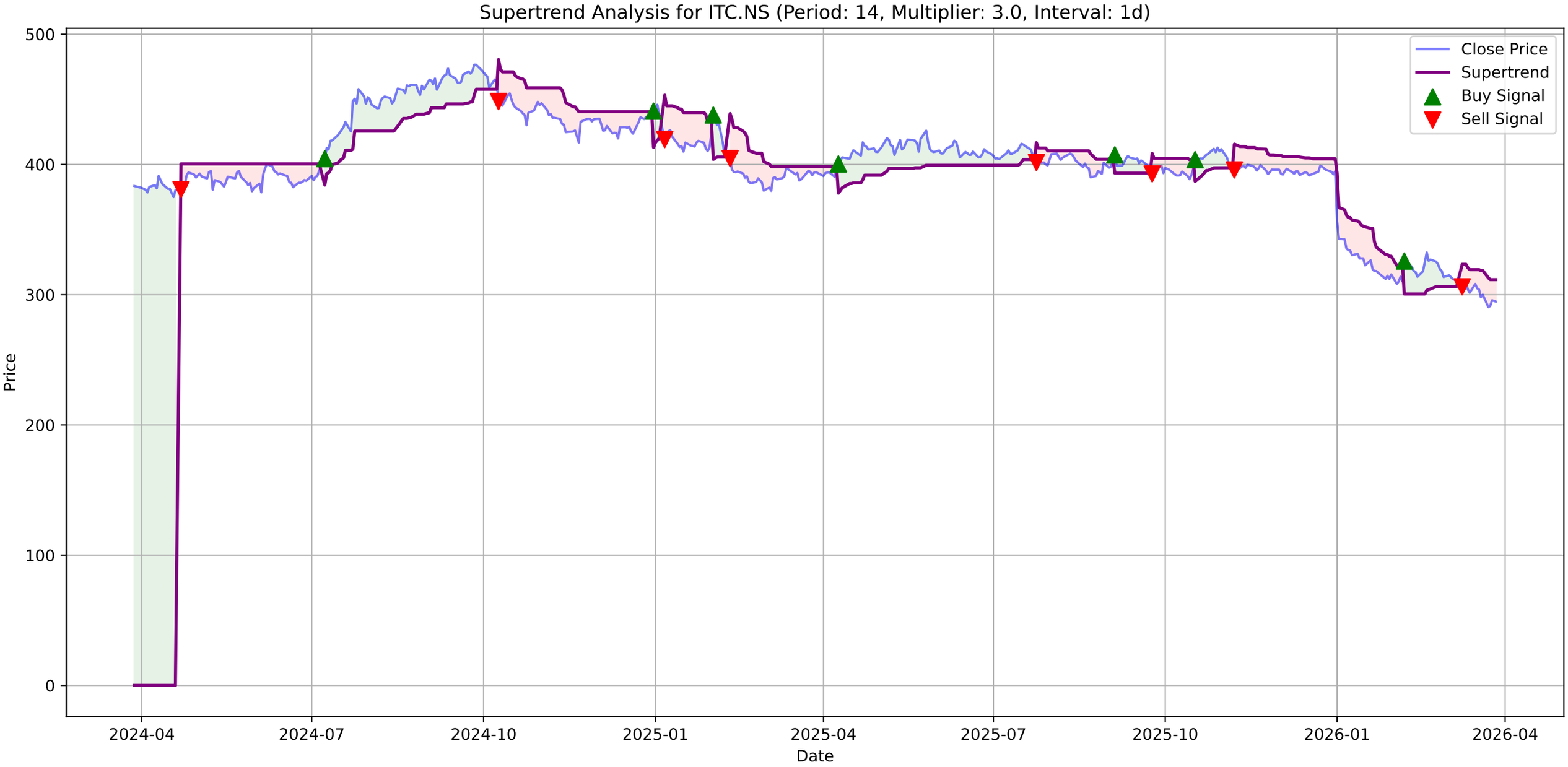
ITC.NS - Bollinger Bands Summary

Current Price:	294.70
Upper Band:	320.65
Middle Band (SMA 20):	304.84
Lower Band:	289.03
%B:	0.1794
Band Width:	0.1037
Status:	Lower Half
Signal:	None
Recent Signal 1:	**Buy Signal at 2026-02-02 00:00:00+05:30**
Recent Signal 2:	**Buy Signal at 2026-03-23 00:00:00+05:30**
Recent Signal 3:	**Buy Signal at 2026-03-24 00:00:00+05:30**


ITC.NS Bollinger Bands (20, 2) Analysis
Close Price
Upper Band
Lower Band
Middle Band (SMA 20)
Price
475
450
425
400
375
350
325
300
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04
Date

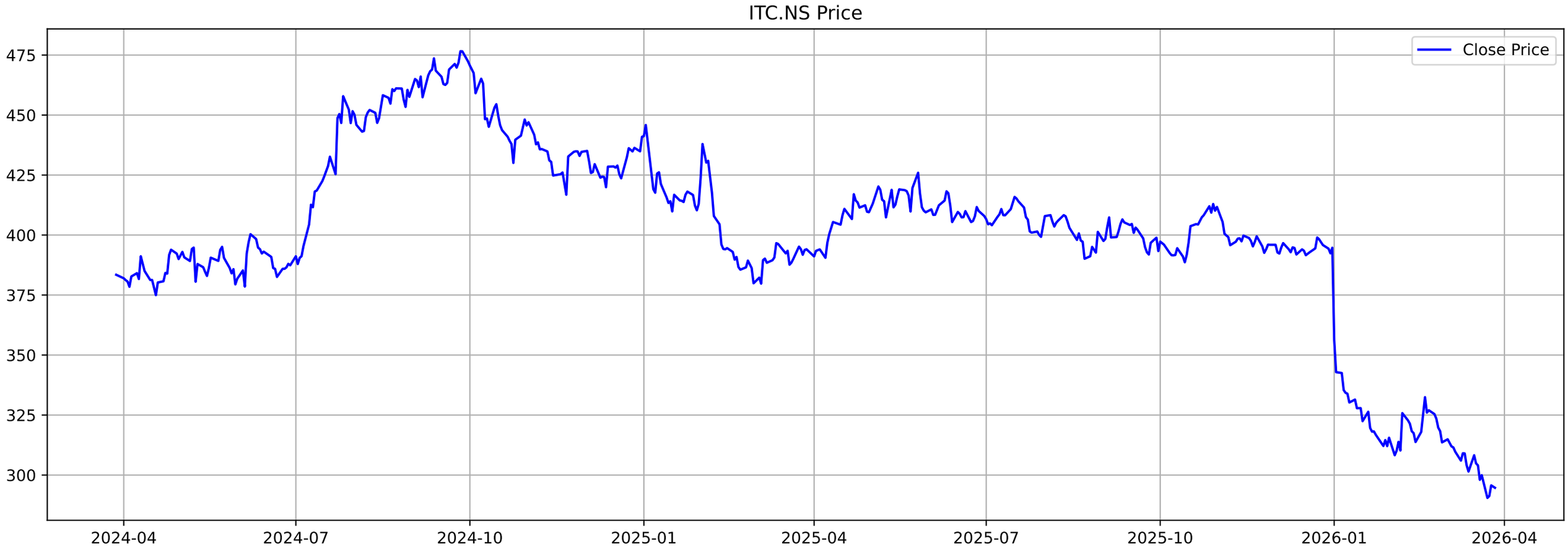
ITC.NS - Supertrend Summary

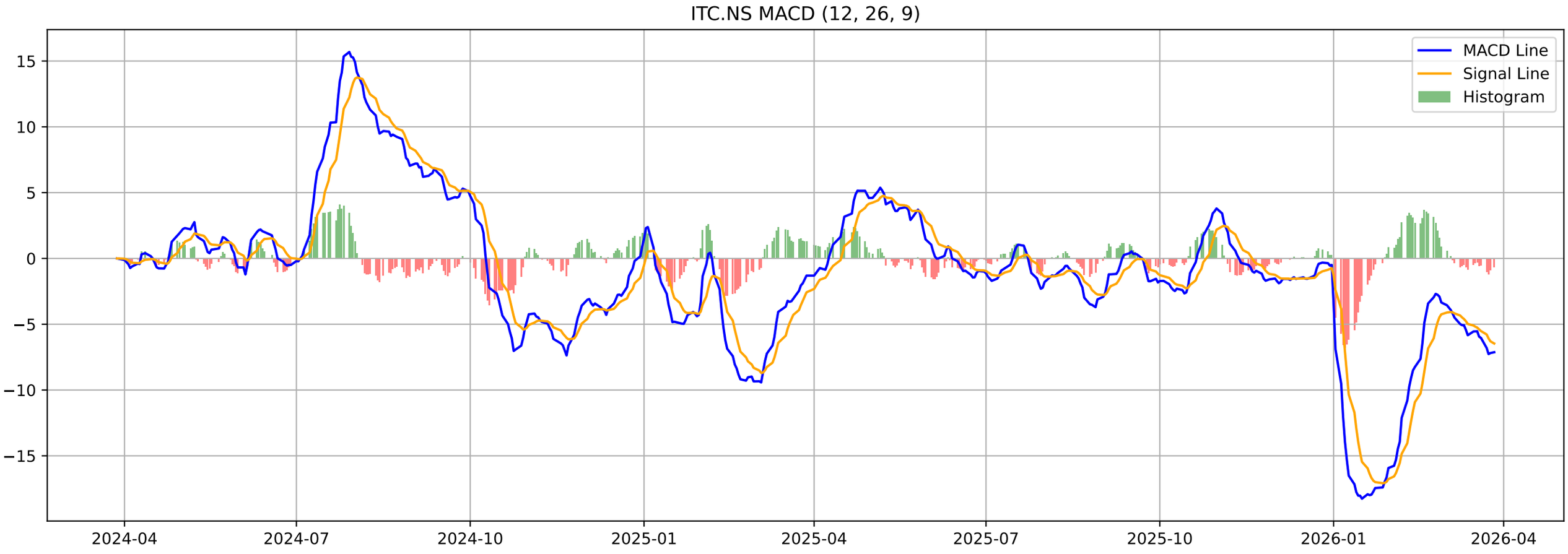
Status:	**DOWNTREND (Sell)**
Supertrend Value:	311.54
Signal Identified On:	2026-03-09


Supertrend Analysis for ITC.NS (Period: 14, Multiplier: 3.0, Interval: 1d)
Close Price
Supertrend
Buy Signal
Sell Signal
Price
Date
500
400
300
200
100
0
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04

ITC.NS - MACD Summary

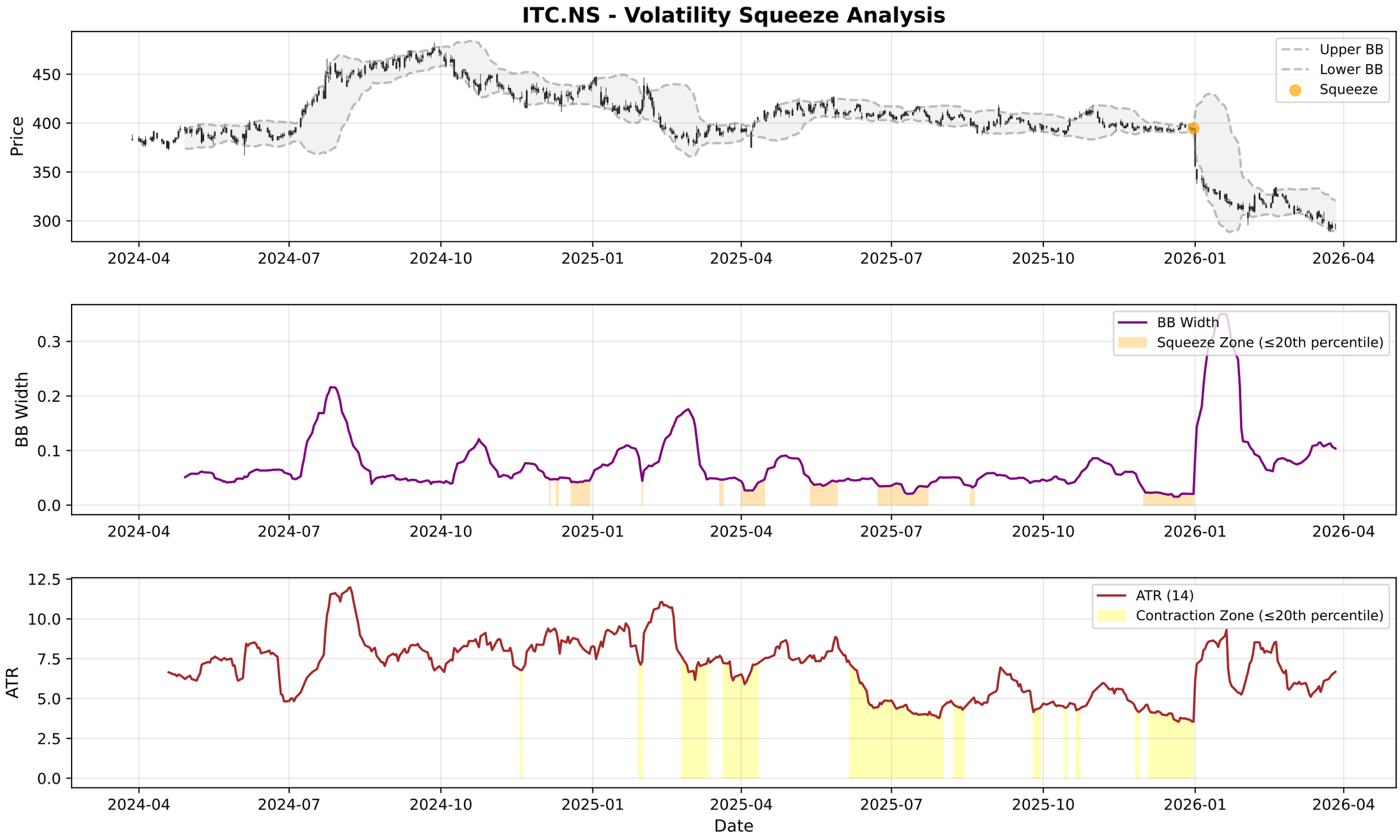
MACD Line:	-7.13
Signal Line:	-6.47
Histogram:	-0.66
Trend:	**Bearish**
Momentum:	**Weakening**
Signal:	None
Divergences Detected:	1
└ **Bullish Divergence:**	Date: 2026-03-23 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 290.45


ITC.NS Price
Close Price
475
450
425
400
375
350
325
300
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04


ITC.NS MACD (12, 26, 9)
MACD Line
Signal Line
Histogram
15
10
5
0
−5
−10
−15
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04

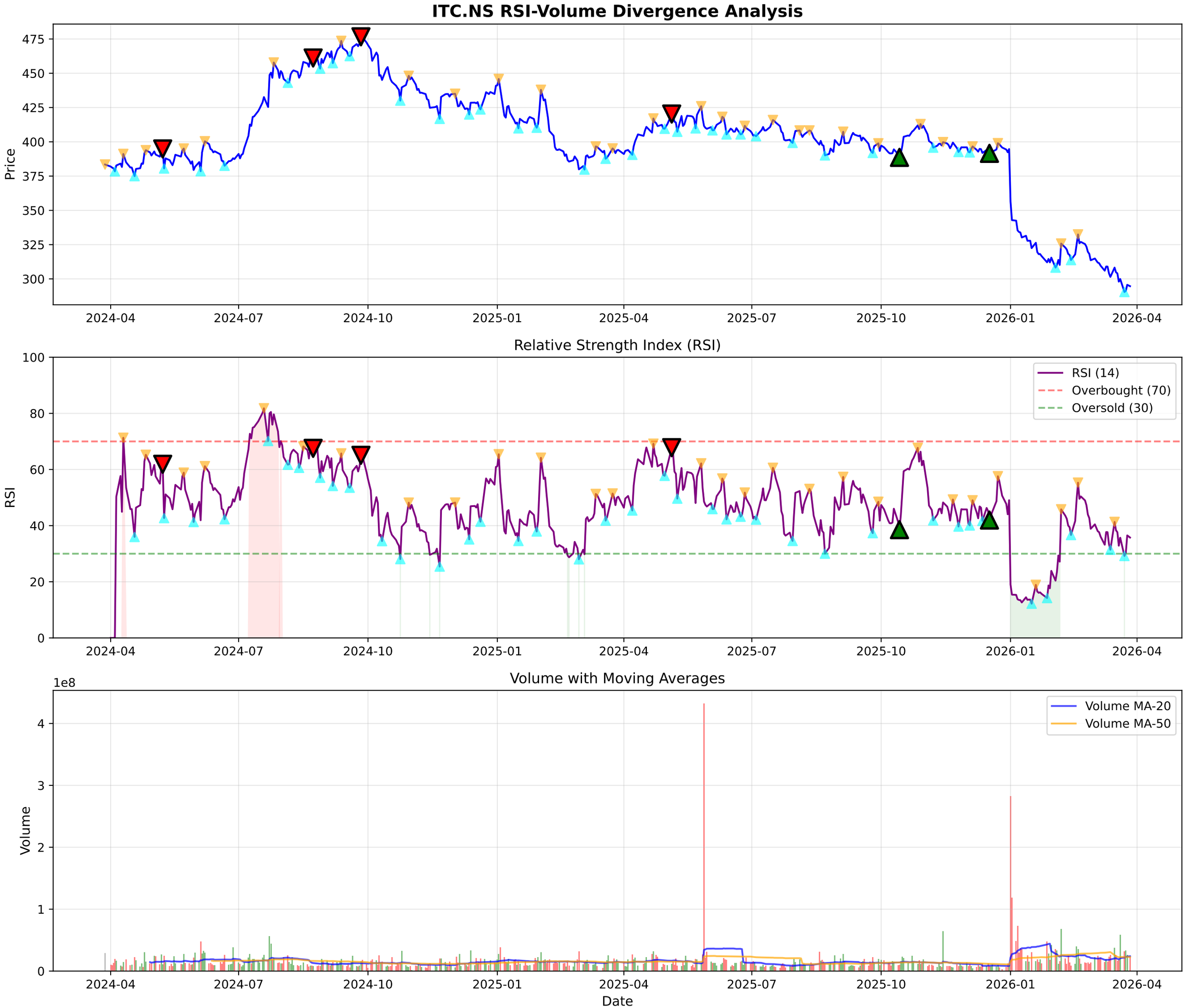
ITC.NS - Volatility Squeeze Summary

BB Width:	0.1037
ATR:	6.6786
Total Signals:	1
Signal 1:	BB Squeeze + ATR Contraction at 2025-12-31 00:00:00+05:30 (Pr


ITC.NS - Volatility Squeeze Analysis
Price
Upper BB
Lower BB
Squeeze
BB Width
BB Width
Squeeze Zone (≤20th percentile)
ATR
ATR (14)
Contraction Zone (≤20th percentile)
Date
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04

ITC.NS - RSI-Volume Summary

Current RSI:	35.76
Current Volume:	22179022
Volume MA 20:	23942558
Bullish Divergences:	2
Bearish Divergences:	4
Bullish Div 1:	Date: 2025-10-14 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 388.65
Bullish Div 2:	Date: 2025-12-17 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 391.59
Bearish Div 1:	Date: 2024-09-26 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 476.59
Bearish Div 2:	Date: 2025-05-05 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 420.24


ITC.NS RSI-Volume Divergence Analysis
Price
475
450
425
400
375
350
325
300
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04
Relative Strength Index (RSI)
RSI
100
80
60
40
20
0
RSI (14)
Overbought (70)
Oversold (30)
Volume with Moving Averages
Volume
1e8
4
3
2
1
0
Volume MA-20
Volume MA-50
Date

ITC.NS - Volume Analysis

═══ VOLUME ANALYSIS ═══:	
Status:	**41 Signals Detected**
:	
2026-03-04 [-]:	Distribution Day
2026-03-06 [-]:	Distribution Day
2026-03-13 [-]:	Distribution Day
2026-03-17 [-]:	Distribution Day
2026-03-20 [-]:	Climax Volume (Churning)

ITC.NS - Volume Analysis
Close Price
Peaks
Troughs
Distribution
Climax Churn
Buying Exhaustion
Selling Exhaustion
Price
420
400
380
360
340
320
300
2025-05
2025-07
2025-09
2025-11
2026-01
2026-03
1e8
Vol MA (20)
Volume
Volume
4
3
2
1
0
Date

ITC.NS - Candlestick Classification Summary

═══ CANDLESTICK CLASSIFICATION ═══:	
Latest Classification:	**No Control**
Recent Trend Score (10-day avg):	-0.50
:	
Distribution:	
No Control:	117
Seller Control:	61
Buyer Control:	47
Seller Strong Control:	2
Buyer Strong Control:	1

ITC.NS - Candlestick Classification
Seller Strong Control
Seller Control
No Control
Buyer Control
Buyer Strong Control
Price
420
400
380
360
340
320
300
1e8
Volume
2.5
2.0
1.5
1.0
0.5
0.0
2025-07-08
2025-08-01
2025-08-29
2025-09-24
2025-10-21
2025-11-18
2025-12-12
2026-01-08
2026-02-04
2026-03-02
Date

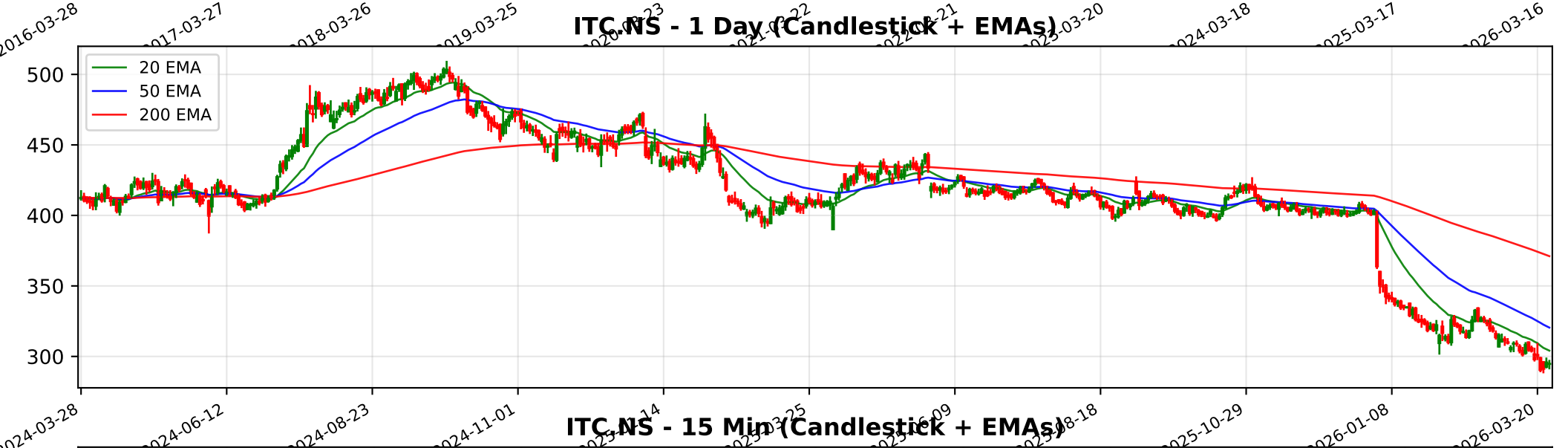
Multi-Timeframe Supertrend Analysis

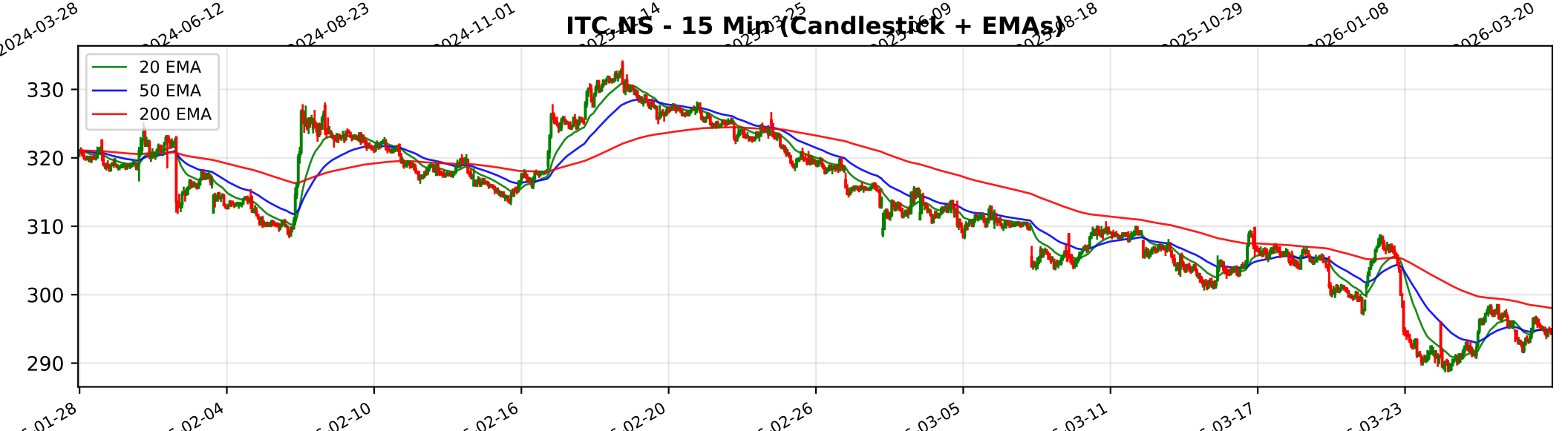
Timeframe	Status	Value	Last Price	Signal Date
1 Week	**DOWNTREND (Sell)**	320.96	294.7	2024-10-07
1 Day	**DOWNTREND (Sell)**	311.54	294.7	2026-03-09
15 Min	**UPTREND (Buy)**	293.01	294.55	2026-03-27

Multi-Timeframe MACD Analysis

Timeframe	Trend	Momentum	Signal
1 Week	**Bearish**	Weakening	No Signal
1 Day	**Bearish**	Weakening	No Signal
15 Min	**Bearish**	Strengthening	No Signal

ITC.NS - 1 Week (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
500
400
300
200
2016-03-28
2017-03-27
2018-03-26
2019-03-25
2024-03-18
2025-03-17
2026-03-16


ITC.NS - 1 Day (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
500
450
400
350
300
2024-03-28
2024-06-12
2024-08-23
2024-11-01
2025-10-29
2026-01-08
2026-03-20


ITC.NS - 15 Min (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
330
320
310
300
290
02-04
02-10
02-16
02-20
02-26
03-05
03-11
03-17
03-23

Trendlyne Snapshot - ITC_main

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ITC Ltd.

Ask MarketMind AI v1.5

NSE: ITC | BSE: 500875

ITC Live Share Price Today, Share Analysis and Chart

Falling Comet

IRAN WAR IMPACT The impact of the Iran-Israel war on ITC Ltd. is categorized as minimal to slightly negative. While the company has an export presence in the region, its primary operations and revenue drivers remain domestic. The most significant risks are i... Read More

294.70 -1.00 (-0.34%)

↓ New 52W Low in past week

24.3M NSE+BSE Volume

NSE 27 Mar, 2026 3:31 PM (IST)

Watchlist | Portfolio | Alert | My Notes

Overview | FORECASTER | STOCK REPORT | Buy Sell Zone | F&O | Financials | News | Reports | Technicals | Shareholding | Deals | Corporate Actions | Alerts | About

Durability score	Valuation Score	Momentum Score	Analyst Price Target
75.0 / 100	46.8 / 100	28.5 / 100	366
High Financial Strength	Mid Valuation	Technically Bearish	1Yr Price target upside is 24%

Falling Comet These stocks have good quality scores. However, their weak technicals make them more bearish

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FORECASTER

DVM | Key Metrics | Price Chart | Forecaster | Financials | Technicals | Shareholding | Deals | Documents | Corporate actions | Company Profile

SWOT Analysis: 16 (S) 9 (W) 5 (O) 2 (T)

Check Before You Buy

VIEW FULL CHECKLIST

High rank 13 Positive • 10 Negative

56.5% Pass in checklist

0 | 45 | 55 | 100

PE Valuation Check

Right Now: Undervalued 124.6%

1 Year Forward: Undervalued 30.7%

INSIGHT High 5Yr PE Avg of 23.7 may distort upside values.

ITC Key Metrics

Preset Metrics: Preset Metrics

ROE Ann. %	Broker Average Target	Market Capitalization	Price to Book
49.6	432.75	369,243.4	4.9
Market Leader	46.84% upside	Market Leader	Above Industry Median

Trendlyne Snapshot - ITC_forecaster

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MARKETS / SECTOR : FOOD, BEVERAGES & TOBACCO / INDUSTRY : CIGARETTES-TOBACCO PRODUCTS / ITC LTD.

ITC Ltd.

NSE: ITC | BSE: 500875

Falling Comet

Download real time STOCK REPORT

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ITC - ITC - stock price prediction, stock forecast, target price, analyst ratings from 34 analysts

ITC has a share price target of Rs 366, revenue growth forecast of 7.4%, and profit growth estimate of -42.2% for FY26, based on top 34 analyst calls.

ITC FORECASTER - Analyst Estimates

FORECASTER DASHBOARD →

SHARE PRICE TARGET FORECAST

12 MONTH ESTIMATE

↑ HIT ITC's share price target is above the current price, with an upside of 24.2%

EPS FORECAST

QUARTER | ANNUAL

↑ HIT ITC's EPS was higher than average estimate 2 times in past 3 years

CONSENSUS RECOMMENDATION

34 ANALYST Recommendations

HOLD

The consensus recommendation from 34 analysts for ITC is HOLD